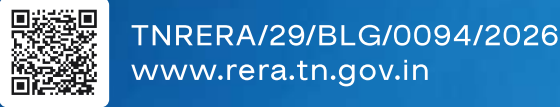


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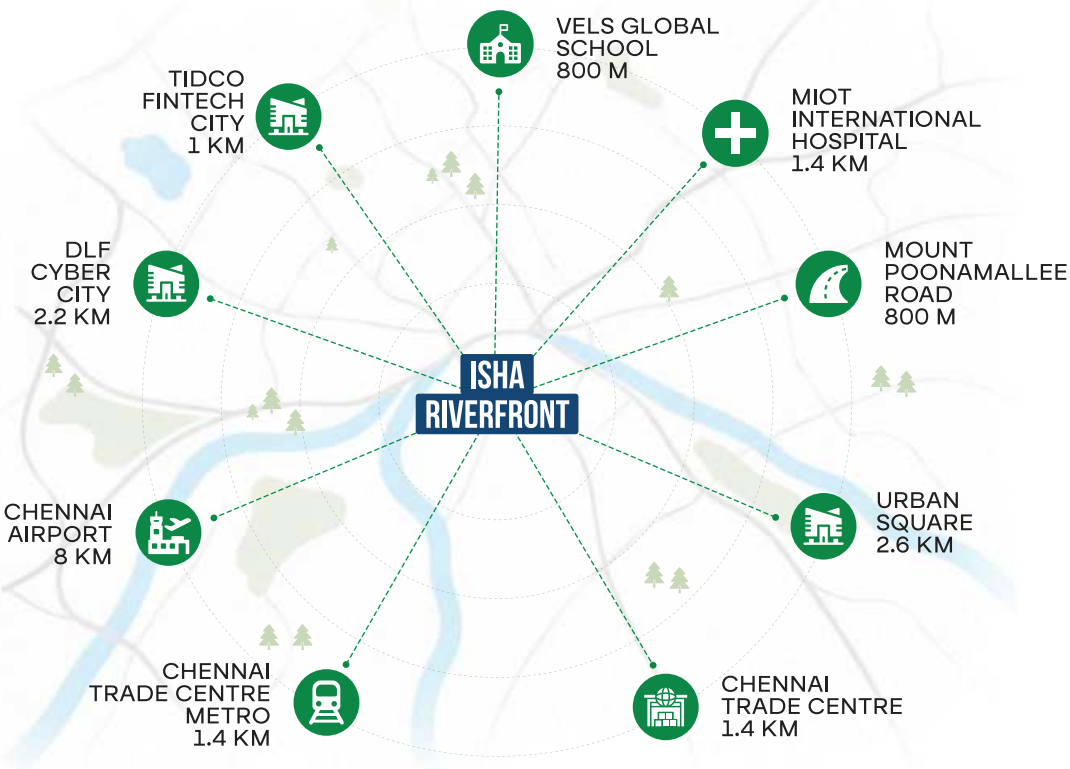
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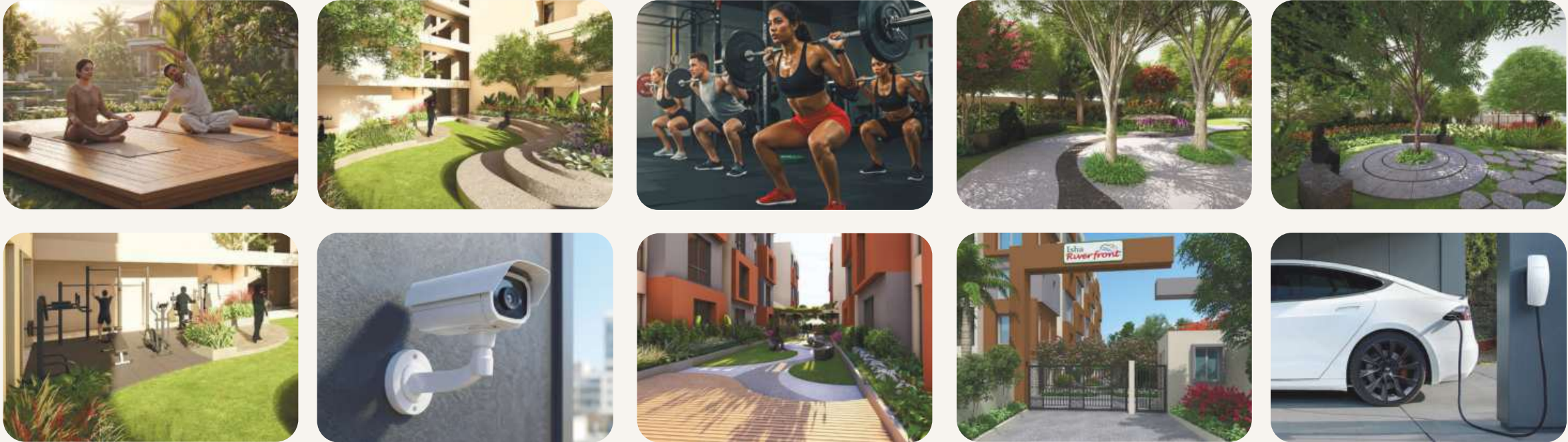
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THE HINDU



COVER

Building better warehouses

From e-commerce to manufacturing, India's growth is driving demand for taller, denser, automated storage systems



Sangeetha Kandavel

The whirring of towering steel coils moving through automated cutting lines greets visitors to the Godrej Enterprises Group's Storage Solutions facility in Chennai's Ambattur. Spread across 26 acres, it is one of Asia's largest and densest storage solutions manufacturing plants. As the facility marks 25 years, Godrej is planning its next phase of expansion around the city.

Today, every online order, supermarket shelf and factory assembly line depends on storage systems that determine how efficiently goods move through the supply chain. As India sees a boom in e-commerce, quick commerce, and manufacturing, its warehouses are becoming smarter, taller and denser. Companies such as Godrej Enterprises Group, Nilkamal, and Spanco Storage Systems are among those benefiting from the shift.

Chennai is one of the country's leading warehousing and industrial markets, underpinned by its strength as a manufacturing hub. Abhishek Bhutani, managing director of logistics & industrial services, Cushman & Wakefield backs this claim with numbers. "The city accounted for 15% of pan-India warehouse and industrial leasing in 2025," he says. "Industrial leasing, in particular, was 23% of the

total, highlighting the city's attractiveness for domestic and global manufacturers."

"With locations such as Sriperumbudur and Oragadam already established as warehouse and industrial hubs, the city is likely to benefit from the growth of emerging locations such as Redhills and Periyapalayam in the medium term," Bhutani adds.

Steel into storage

"We set up the plant in Chennai as we needed port facilities. We are currently exporting over 25% [manufactured goods]," says Vikas Choudaha, business head, Storage Solutions, Godrej Enterprises Group. The Chennai facility offers around 100,000 tonnes of storage and intralogistics solutions. Here, steel is transformed into beams. The robotic welding systems, at one section of the factory floor, are capable of producing up to 2,000 beams a day.

Back at the facility, once the beams are ready, they are moved to the painting line, where they are coated based on customer specifications. While dark blue, orange and yellow are among the most commonly used colours (bright hues enhance visibility), customers can choose shades as per their branding requirements. Every product undergoes quality testing. Key checks include powder-coating tests to assess weather re-

sistance and salt sprays to evaluate corrosion resistance. They pick up samples from each batch and test it, the plant manager explains. The finished beams are dispatched to customer sites, and assembled and installed according to the available space and the design.

Godrej's Chennai unit manufactures a wide range of storage products, including picking solutions, shelving systems, racking solutions and palletised systems for customers across industries. Simply put, it manufactures storage infrastructure that helps warehouses organise goods safely, save space, and move products efficiently. Goods such as refrigerators and washing machines are stored on giant metal shelves.

Rising demand

In 2025, Bhutani says, "Pan-India, Grade A warehousing market stock stood at 268 million sq. ft., and warehousing and industrial leasing stood at 66 million sq. ft., with a 26% year-on-year growth, highlighting the strong demand. Chennai Grade A warehouse stock stood at 42 million sq. ft, accounting for 16% of the total pan-India stock."

Godrej's Chennai plant has also been supporting industries, including FMCG, retail, automotive, pharmaceuticals, etc.



PLI [production linked incentive] schemes and Make in India initiatives boost industrial storage needs. Demand is also expanding rapidly in tier-2 and tier-3 cities, thereby expanding storage solutions beyond the metros

VIKAS CHOUDAHA
Business head, Storage Solutions, Godrej Enterprises Group



We invest ₹10-₹12 crore in storage solutions and warehouse infrastructure for large warehouses, spanning approx. 80,000-1,00,000 sq. ft. of size, and ₹6-₹8 crore in smaller facilities of 50,000-60,000 sq. ft.

AJAY RAO
CEO and founder, Emiza

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 7



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The Curva Luxe Bouclé is a thoughtfully-designed piece that brings together quality craftsmanship and everyday comfort. With its organic curves and textured bouclé fabric, the three-seater's warm beige blends with any décor palette. Handmade by skilled artisans, customisation is also available on request.

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Entertain in style with the Ameli dining table. Made from solid mango wood, with a rich burnt honey finish, the table is handcrafted and will add a refined touch to any setting. The timeless design means it can work for both classic and contemporary interiors.

Available: lakkadhaara.com

A weekly round-up of indicative property prices in one area of Chennai that shows how the value of real estate has moved over the last five years.

THIS WEEK: **MANDAVELI**

Segment	2021 (₹ per sq.ft.)	2026
Luxury Apartments	19,000	22,500
Premium Apartments	16,500	19,000
Budget Apartments	14,000	NA

Source: JLL

Material	This Week	Material	This Week
CEMENT		BLUE METAL	
CEMENT PER 50 KG BAG (BULK-300 BAGS)	₹310/-	12 mm	₹65/- per cft
		20 mm	₹65/- per cft
CEMENT PER 50 KG BAG (RETAIL)	₹330/-	40 mm	₹65/- per cft
		BITUMEN AT I.O.C. (bulk)	
STEEL		Grade 80/100 (VG 10) MT	₹90,413/-
TMT 8 mm & 32 mm	₹73,000/-	Grade 60/70 (VG 30) MT	₹91,593/-
TMT 12-25 mm	₹71,000/-	LABOUR	
		MASON	Per day
BRICKS 3000 Nos	₹39,000/-	MEN	Per day
P. SAND	₹70/- per cft	WOMEN	Per day
M.SAND	₹60/- per cft	PAINTER/ PLUMBER	Per day
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Source : Builders Association of India (Southern Centre) Inclusive of taxes			

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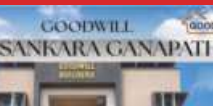
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Rashmi Gopal Rao

As we evolve and grow, our homes should evolve too. Whether it is a growing family or a work-from-home requirement, repairing or replacing ageing fixtures, renovating the space, or giving it a makeover are integral in the lifecycle of a home.

Opting for a full-fledged renovation often comes with challenges that homeowners should carefully consider. From budget overruns and extended timelines to temporary lifestyle disruptions and decision fatigue, the process can be quite demanding. Beyond the financial investment, it requires a significant amount of time and emotional bandwidth.

“Over the years, I have advised many clients considering a full renovation to think about the mental load involved as much as the budget,” says Anil Badan, principal architect and founder of Delhi-based Studio B Architects. “When an existing structure is dismantled, hidden issues often come to light: temporary fixes, ageing systems, or unforeseen conditions. These can impact both timelines and costs.”

Badan adds that good design is often about refinement rather than replacement. “Small interventions can have a remarkably large impact when applied thoughtfully,” he says. Thus, most of the time, retaining the existing structure and reimagining the space within is the more practical and efficient approach to any makeover.

“Unless there are truly compelling reasons for structural changes, I strongly recommend prioritising pocket interventions,” says Sonali Bhagwati, design partner at Gurugram-based Designplus Architecture. “This approach is a more effective strategy to refresh your home without excessive disruption or unforeseen costs.”

While considering a makeover, it is always recommended that you concentrate on the places you spend the most time in. “Rather than allocating the budget throughout the house, it is better to revamp the areas that are most used,” says Badan. “This not only allows you to enhance the appearance of

the space, but also the usability.”

High-visibility areas include the living room, dining space, entrance or foyer, and the master bedroom. “Allocate budgets for elements that are seen and used daily too, such as sofas, dining tables, beds, and accent chairs. Well-curated furniture and a styling upgrade can often achieve the feel of a completely refreshed home without the cost and disruption of extensive civil work,” says Atul Yadav, creative director of Delhi-based design consultancy Astoria Living. Even modest upgrades in the foyer – think statement consoles, mirrors, artwork, or decorative lighting – can create a strong first impression, he adds, and improve the way the overall house is perceived.

Here are five strategies you can adopt to revamp your house on a budget.

Lighting upgrade

Replacing old fixtures with modern pendants or lamps can change the look of a room. It is also important to think of lighting from a functional perspective and not merely as decorative. “You can always experiment with adding layers of light. It instantly warms up the space and makes it more comfortable,” says Bhagwati. “Brass and powder-coated metal fixtures and fabric shades go a long way in accentuating the ambience of a space. It is crucial to maintain consistent colour temperature throughout and avoid over-lighting.”

According to Bhumi Shah, founder of 18Studioz, a multidisciplinary architecture and design firm based in Mumbai, chandeliers, wall sconces and floor lamps can reshape a



room’s vibe. “Replacing old bulbs with LED lights can bring in brightness, and with different types of ambient lights, you can metamorphose your entire house,” says Shah.

Surface treatments

“With just one feature wall, you can add a whole new personality to the space,” says Badan. “Try textured paint, wallpaper, limewash, fluted MDF panelling, fabric panelling or even veneer. It does not need big renovations, just the right colours and textures.” It is recommend-

ed to focus on one feature wall rather than experimenting with many, which will only add to visual clutter.

Laminates, membrane finishes, PU (polyurethane) paint and acrylic sheets are great ideas to remodel your kitchen cabinets and drawers without replacing them. While laminates that work for flat surfaces are pocket friendly and easy to maintain, membrane finishes can be used on curves, rounded corners and arched profiles. If you are a fan of smooth finishes, give PU paints a shot. Opt

for acrylic finishes if you prefer a glossy appearance, which is not only scratch resistant but also has a mirror-like reflective quality.

Refresh hardware

According to Badan, swapping out handles and knobs (without replacing entire kitchen or wardrobe cabinets) can make a huge difference, and not be too heavy on the pocket. Some popular materials include brushed brass, stainless steel and antique bronze. “Materials like matt black aluminium,

brushed stainless steel, leather-wrapped handles, or even wooden handles can refresh the look of a cabinet or wardrobe while being easy to maintain and functional,” adds Shah. “Wood and leather add warmth and tactility, while textured metal hides scratches and fingerprints, and lends a clean, elegant aesthetic.” It is important to check existing fixtures to minimise additional carpentry work while undertaking this exercise.

Lifestyle corners

It is not uncommon for homes to have unused corners. These can be turned into cosy spots for reading, drinking coffee, playing music, or working. “These makeovers cost almost nothing, yet can enhance daily life at home,” says Bhagwati. “Some of the recommended additions include an accent chair, a side table, a bookshelf, artwork, and task lighting. Ensure that you keep the corner visually connected to the rest of the room rather than treating it as an isolated feature.” Choose an area with plenty of natural light and throw in an unused cane chair, floor cushions and a few plants to curate a relaxing corner.

Soft furnishing

The right textiles and fabrics can make a big difference in how spaces look and feel. “Soft furnishing brings character, colour and comfort without altering the room’s structure. Consider reupholstering a good sofa rather than buying a new one,” says Nirmala Banaji, principal architect of Banaji & Associates, an integrated design practice in Mumbai. “Go for materials like linen, cotton blends, wool rugs, and textured weaves. Work with a cohesive palette and avoid introducing too many competing patterns.”

She adds that accessories can help “finish” the space. “Place a mirror to reflect more light, hang art for personal flair, and add plants to tie the room to nature smoothly. Always remember fewer, larger pieces often create more impact than several smaller items.”

The Bengaluru-based freelance writer is passionate about all things design, travel, food, art and culture.



(Clockwise from top) Anil Badan; Nirmala Banaji; Sonali Bhagwati; Atul Yadav; and examples of home interiors after makeovers.
TANYA GUPTA PHOTOGRAPHY AND SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Muskaan Sarin

There have been significant changes in India’s residential market. One of the most prominent is the demand for ready-to-move-in houses. It is not just a phase, but rather a big shift in how consumers are looking at residential development.

In the past, under construction development dominated residential markets because they allowed flexible payment schemes and offered cheaper prices. This also meant consumers would tolerate delays of up to several years before taking possession of their purchases. The current scenario is quite different.

Certainty and trust

One of the benefits of ‘ready homes’ is the high degree of certainty in them. The customer can examine the building from inside, see how well the work has been done, learn about its structure and get familiar with its surroundings without spending any money on it.

Trust is another aspect that cannot be overlooked. Construction delays in the last 10

No wait, all gain

Demand for ready-to-move-in houses reflects changing priorities among India’s urban homebuyers



years have had a great impact on consumer behaviour. As a result, people today are increasingly preferring to buy house where work has already been completed. It helps differentiate projects in a competitive city market. It also becomes important for those who might be shifting houses because of their careers and who wouldn’t want to wait for years to get a possession certificate.

Financial benefits

A practical aspect is the financial one. People opting for ready-to-move-in houses save themselves the burden of pay-

ing rent and mortgage on under construction homes.

The current generation of buyers is also careful when it comes to the overall living experience. Expectations have been raised not only about timelines for possession, but also about things such as privacy, proper planning, lower density, greenery and availability of facilities.

Keeping with the trend

People are not just looking to acquire houses, they want to see how well a residential development merges with its urban ecosystem – which would be key to them achieving long-term goals such as home-work balance, lifestyle quality and asset value.

Developers are now reworking their strategy to keep up with the trend. No doubt, regulatory changes and robust systems of compliance that have increased transparency in the sector are also helping this momentum. In the coming years, the demand is set to become even more pronounced.

The writer is CBO and director of TARC Ltd.

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BUNGALOW/ HIGHEND Flat/ House/ Land Wanted in Prime Chennai 9884988604	
WANTED BUNGALOW/ Land/Flat/House in SOUTH Chennai.NoBrokers 9790729408	
NRI-REQUIRED BUNGLOW, LAND/ Flat, Comm/Ind, Warehouse, Noag 9825480492	
WANTED 2,3,4 BHK Apt T.Ngr, Nungambkam, Anna Ngr, Adyar. Ct. 9884067525	
REQ ANNA Nagar Kilpauck mogappair 1 to 10 grounds Land bungalow flat any prime area S.U.H 9884588199	
RESIDENTIAL FLAT	
WANTED 1500SFT & 3000SFT of Premium flat in Alwarpet/ R A Puram/ Mylapore/ Nungambakkam/ Adyar. Ct. RKGS Group 99412 49719	
RESIDENTIAL LAND	
WANTED PALAVAKKAM To Panaiyur Sea side Appd Land Only Above 500Mtrs From Beach No Broker Ct: 9003366995	
REQ 1ACRE ON ECR Beach Side Near Mahabalipuram Brk Excuse 8608341807	
ECR AKKARAI Sea Cliff Layout 2-6Grds Regd. Only Owners Ct : 9840365877	
WANTED 1-2GR Vengadamangalam Kat-tobannam Ngr, Shanathi Ngr. 9841038457	
5 ACRES required on OMR and other places. Ct shankhar 9677086749	
WANTED 2 Grounds in Kottivakkam Palavakkam Inmd Settlement. 9500049167	
WANTED PROPERTY Around South Chennai. Immediate settlement. Contact: 9790736554 Brokers excuse	
GST OMR ECR in & Around Nend CMDA DTCP Layout for Marketing 8438923345	
CONSULTANTS	
BUILDING PLAN Approval 25yrs Serviced & Expd in TP Dept/GCC 8825530329	
JOINT VENTURE Advisor, 40Years exp To Advise Landlords to get a Good Deal with Promoters. 9716727247	
JOINT DEVELOPMENT	
THAIYUR 25GROUNDS Available for JV Near Sriiram Layout. Ct : 9380540118	
ECR MUTTUKADU 4GrVJ & Nemili Lake View 6Gr Per Gr Rs.35L 9500162224	

FARMHOUSE / LAND / RESORTS

ARCOIT NEAR 50cents Suitable for Farm 26Lakh Contact: 9360204487

COMBATORE 10ACRES DTCP Appd Layout for Sale Prime Area Ct: 9894967388

NEAR MAHINDRA World City & Singaporemalkovil : Very Close to Upcoming 3rd Outer Ring Road - CPRR - Chennai Peripheral Ring Road - Mahabalipuram To Ennore Port 1.5-2 Premium 1.2 & 5 Acres Assured Good ROI Cosmic Properties 90477 34343

ORAGADAM LAND 17308 sqft 3BHK Pool, Well, 100 Trees 2.10cr. 9884088660

ECR 5GR with Bungalow Apprd Injambakkam Cing Beach No Bro 9840045676

TIRUTTANI NEAR Kanagamma Chathiram 16acre Agriculture Land: 9884314471

GENERAL

PLOT FOR SALE: 3138 Sq.Ft, North-facing, near Guduvanchery Bus Terminus. Contact: 9380297542.

ANNANGR, TNGR Prime Properties Sale only Direct Buyers Cont. 8939934344

RESIDENTIAL

3BHK FLAT FOR SALE - Baraka Road, Kelys Car Parking & Lift Facility 12 Years old Property, 984096189

CHEPPE 2 Gr. Annanagar 1.5Gr 5000sqft 7BHK Bungalow Sale.Ct. 9962083555

PALAVAKKAM PERIYAR Salai 3600sqft, 4600sqft Builtp 2 Flats Rental 1.20L & 90K 6CrS Nego Ct: 9500027059

ECR ON rd 2acre & Beachside 2/3/5grd, Tngr 3/2/5grd Noagt 882540492

RESIDENTIAL FLAT - NEW

KODAMBAKKAM PARUVASAPURAM St 2BHK 955.9935ft.9551331234 / 9444064567

KILPAUK 1863SFT NF 20CP Good Loc & Building Lift Genset. Ct.9840720085

NANGANALLUR THILLAI Ganga Ngr 450 Sft Cntrl, 1450 Sft 3 BHK 7200303131

READY TO move Kundrathur, Mananchan 828 sq.ft., 2 bhk BNC Nagappa Shelters 9566241333.

VELACHERY 2BHK Flat for Sale Near Chennai Silks Ct : Majestic Foundation Varsham 9841042873 / 9384661112

CHOOALAMEDU BAJANAOKIL St 3BHK 1480 Sft 5BHK 2170 Sft Handing over June 2027 Offer Price Rs. 12000/sft CCP/Lift Power Backup Cntrl 9444862005

CHINMAYA NAGAR Chithirai St VR Nr to Metro Stn & Chinmaya Sthl 3BHK 1716 & 1415 SFT CCP LIFT CCTV Generator Handing Over Sep 2027 9444862005

Porur - Manapakkam River view colony 2500sft 4BHK 4th flr. 9444610256

KODAMBAKKAM - TRUSTPURAM New Spacious 3 BHK Road-Facing 1st Floor. Lift, Car Parking, 500 Mtrs from Kodambakkam Metro Station. Immediate Sale, Brokers Excuse Contact : 93455 02494

NUNGAMBAKKAM FANTASTIC 5BHK Flats Sale (1 Flat in 1 Floor). 9840965103

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR PREMIUM 3BHK Vasthu CCP Flat for sale Ct:9962099997

AMBATTUR PREMIUM 3BHK Flat vasthu CCP Lift Flat for sale Ct:9962099997

ADYAR, READY to Move 2BHK, 966 SFT, 2nd floor, Solar, Access Entry, Genset, EV, Lift till Terrace, 1.95 Cr. Ph: 9342912618 www.vamanas.co.in

ANNANAGAR WEST, 3BHK, 1200 sqft UDS 45%, West face 10CP 30ft Road No Brokers. MODERN SPACES: 9992181181

KODAMBAKKAM 3BHK 1508 & 1440 sft. Solar, Access Entry, Genset, EV, Lift till Terrace, Sep 2026. Ph: 93429 12618 www.vamanas.co.in

NANGANALLUR -THILLAI Ganga Nagar - 26th Street Ready to occupy 2.5 BHK/2 BHK Apartments Viji Associates : 9940043234 / 9841603650

RAMAPURAM

RAYALA NAGAR - 2nd Main Road
Deluxe 3-BHK Flats - 1,155 Sq.ft

Just 2 Flats Left
Hurry up !!
Ready to Occupy

SAKTHI FOUNDATION
94442 43892, 98848 43892

VALASARAVAKKAM 3BHK 5flrs Ngr EB Off Narain Promoters 9844113194

THORAIAPPAKKAM New Customizable 2/3 4 BHK Flats 98L onwards 78100 25909

PUZUTHIVAKKAM New Customizable 1/2 BHK Flats 43L onwards 78100 25909

RAMAPURAM New Customizable 2/3/4 BHK Flats 73L onwards 78100 25909

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR 2nd / 3 BHK for sale 87L onwards 78100 25909

RAPURAM OPP Park Warren Road New 1940sft 3.8Cr Ct: 9841295558

✓ HARRINGTON 5TH Av Behind Starbucks New 3BHK 4.75Cr Ct : 9841747262

✓ BESANT NAGAR MGR Road New 2246sft 4BHK 5.75Cr Ct: 9841295558

VALASARAVAKKAM PRIME Location Ready to occupy 1150 Sft, 2.5 BHK, CP, Lift Video Smart Door,CCTV, Nr Metro, 7338838282

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR, LUXURIOUS 1050sqft , 2BHK, CCP, Lift, Close to Metro, SRK CONSTRUCTIONS: 9808397355, 9840957621

✓ VELACHERY - Ready-to-Move 2BHK Flats 870 to 965 Sq.Ft., Lift, CCP, Modular Kitchen: Keerthi Constructions: 98409 77655

KILPAUK NEW SECRETARIAT COLONY, 2418 / 1209sqft.4 / 3BHK North facing, 2CCP, Lift, VDP, Power Backup Ct: 9841210852 / 9808650425

ADAMBAKKAM NEAR Alandur Court 2 BHK with Lift, CCP, Ready to Occupy Ct: Vijayalakshmi Flats 89393 23456

TEYNAMPET BEHIND Semmozhi Pongra Nr Gemini Flyover New 1B/2B Brs Flats 3rd Flr Lift/Parking 8072428837

MADIPPAKKAM, RAM 1400 North, Sunshine School back 1040/1200 sft 2.5 BHK 1CP, CCP Ct.9841551085/ 7358533566.

CHITLAPPAKKAM NEW 2BHK 820 -1001sft Rera Appd Ready Occupancy. 9884503500

MAHALINGAPURAM New Flat for sale 1009sqft Prime Location Ct.9840472738

VIRUGAMBAKKAM NEW 3BHK Flats, Completion By Sep 2026. PH : 6262575761

VADAPALANI 2BR 1.5C Nnalar 2/3 BR 1.15/1.8C PuVkm 2/3BR Ct. 9862192721

RESIDENTIAL FLAT - NEW

TRICHY THILLAI Ngr 3BR 1700sft SRI-RANGAM 2/3 BR Lift, CCP. 9962192721

LIMITED 3BHK Homes in Chetpet & T.Nagar. 1809 & 1960 Sq.Ft. Enquire Today: 63851 64645

LAST FEW High-Rise 3BHK Homes in Korattur. 1342 Sq.Ft. Ready to Move. Call: 63851 64642

BOOK YOUR Site Visit for Premium 3BHK Homes in Defence Colony, Ekkatuthangal. 1500 Sq.Ft. Ct: 63851 64640

ARUMBAKKAM - Near Kola Perumal School 1 Premium 3BHK 1600 Sq.Ft. 1 Last 2 Units Left 1 Possession Dec 2026 1 Call: 73581 06234

MANAPPAKKAM: MODERN 2BHK Premium Homes at IFS Colony. Minutes from Rajiv Centre, MIOH Hospitals, Metro & Airport. Ready for flout, Starting From Rs. 1.76 Cr. Ct: 044 - 4949 4468

PERUNGUDI: READY to Occupy Premium 2 & 3 BHK Lake View Apartments at Perungudi, OMR (Behind world Trade Centre), Special Price Rs. 1.19 Cr Onwards. Limited time Offer. Ct: 044 - 4618 4486

PALLAVARAM: PREMIUM Ready-to-move 2 & 3 BHK Apartments from Rs. 58L Possession in just 10 days! Hurry, limited units! (962 to 1431). Ct: 044 - 4949 4512

CHITLAPPAKKAM BABU Cross St. 1647Sft, 3BHK Ind.Floor Flat. All Amenities Avl. Ph: 9445003833 / 9445003837

LAST CHANCE - PADUR, OMRI Sea-Facing 3 BHK Apts. 1455 sq.ft. Opp. Chettinad Healthcare, Rs. 93 Lakhs onwards. Handover in Just 10 Days! Don't Miss! Call: 044-4949 4514

THORAIAPPAKKAM: READY to Occupy Lake Facing Homes 2 BHK from Rs. 86L Handover in just 15 days (1033 to 2432 sq.ft) Ct: 044 - 4949 4515

GUDUVANCHERY: OWN a dream home behind SRM College! 2 & 3 BHK with Rs. 25,000 assured monthly rent! Call: 044 - 4618 4425

ADYAR INDRANGIR New Flat 1639sft 3BR N/F, F.Flr UDS 60% 10Flats, 2CCP Lift Genset 50ftRd 4.18Cr. 9444019575

ANNANGR(E) 2BHK 1020sqft E/F 2nd-FR UDS 50L/Lft, Gen.CCP 2Cr 9841013369

BESANT NGR PrimeLoc 3100SF 3.5BHK PtTerrace UDS 1100SF 8C. 9710424456

SALIGRAMAM: 3BHK Spacious apartments with Lifestyle Amenities from 1838 - 1917 sq.ft @ Arunachalam Rd from Rs 2.7Cr onwards; Ct: 90424 24090

KILPAUK - Ready to Occupy 3BHK Luxury Apartment, 1896 Sq.ft, 2CCP. Prime Location. Ct:95000 16699

CHINMAYANMIYUR Ready to Occupy 3BHK Divine Apartment, 1375 to 1470 Sft. 1 CCP.Prime Location.Ct:95000 16699

PERUNGUDI PREMIUM 3 BHK Residences, 1579-1784 SR, 1 CCP, Ct:95000 16699

KOTTURUPPAM PREMIUM 3 BHK Flat 1965 Sq.ft 2ccp UDS 840 S.U.H 9841702999

GOPALAPURAM PREMIUM 5BHK Flat 3000 Sq.CCP NF UDS 1000 S.U.H 9841702999

MANDAVELI BRAND new 3BHK with CCTV Security Genset CCP Ct: 9710156179

RESIDENTIAL FLAT - RESALE

THIRUVANMIYUR, PRIME location, 3BHK 1379 SF, Semifurnished, Lift, CC, 15 Yr Old, 1.68C, 95000043077

OMR THORAIAPPAKKAM 2BHK 1227Sft UDS 4135ft 9th Flr Lift, CCP. 9841732166

CHROMPET KUMARAN kundram Tmpl Nr 2640sf 4BHK NF, Neg 2. 20c:7999944473

PURVA WINDERMERE Pallikaranai Lake View 2710sf 4BHK Semi Furnished 2.92Cr 2160sf 3BHK 1.65Cr and 1245sf 3BHK 90Lakh with Dedicated CP. Ct TLS Consultancy 9940084972/ 9566409799

MADRURAYAL NR Vasanta Bayan Adj BOB 2BHK Flat B 1105sf 1Ft Fr EF Gen CP Gym 92L. 9962570101

9444288542

PALLIKARANAI OPP DAV School, 1BHK-600sf, 2BHK-900sf. 10yrs. 9840443624

2BHK FLAT Resale North Facing Ground floor Kilpauck 9445435581

✓ ECR, PENTHOUSE, 14th Floor, 3600 Sq.Ft, Fully furnished, Panoramic Sea View, 2 C.P., Power back-up, Club House, Rs.12,500 Per Sq.ft. ResaleVeedu.Com: Call: 95000 95003

✓ MADIPPAKKAM, 3 BHK, 1578 Sq.ft, UDS 934, CCP, Lift, Rs.6900 P.531 ResaleVeedu.com: Call: 95000 95003

TEYNAMPET 3BHK 1185sf UDS 725sf 1CP 20yr NoBroker 7550208545/ 8754516444

KILPAUK OFF. Taylors Road 3BHK BUA-7000Sft, House 1688sf, 3BHK Duplex Compliant MODERN SPACES- 999218181

KILPAUK TAYLORS Road 1300sf 3 BHK First Floor 1 C.P. Ph: 80728 29970

SAIDAPET JONES Rd Behind community 3BR Flat 1350sf CP 1.80CR 9380302646

MONTIEH ROAD Flat 935Sft 2BHK 81K UDS 259 425R Ct. 9841280569

ADYAR GANDHINGR 3BHK Flat 1690sf Uds 1550sf CCP E/F 2.5Cr. 9551264500

T NAGAR 2&3BHK 1.10CrS to 2.50CrS Balcony, Gen, Lift, CCP. 9940013221

THIRUVANMIYUR South Avenue 2BHK 1000sft 14yr Insight Realty 9150244474

KILPAUK, WELL designed , 3 Bedroom Apt, ctt.2152 sft, Hemdev'S : 9840024444 / 8056598091

WEST MAMBALAM 1457sf 3BHK UDS 600sf 1st Flat per Floor 3yrs South Rs.2.10Cr (Neg). 8122653763, 8870752917

TNAGAR, NEAR Burkitt Rd South Dhandapani St Semi Furnished 3BHK 1800 sft UDS 1200 sft Grd Flr Lift, 2 CCP 23yrs old. Buyers Only, 9789522759

ANNANAGAR W.E near SBOA School 40ft Rd, SBU-1350-2BHK 3BALC, Common 2CCP, 650+ UDS, NE Apts with Lift. For Res/ Office. 8486971797

W. MAMBALAM 2005 Sqft 3Br Bk, Duplex 1220 UDS 2 Cr. Nego. Ct. 9884781912

MADIPPAKKAM 2BHK 920Sft, 450UDS 15yrs 1stFlr A.V Ngr Phase3:9620813013

MADIPPAKKAM Nr Trims 2BHK Build 1075sft CCP,lift NF 70L-77081 73189

N'bakkam Nelson court-5bhk, 3300sf 920/UDS/30yrs,3Cr,lift.Ct:9840108071

POESGARH HIGHEIND 4800Sft 4BHK+Servt.4Cr 4CCP 4yrs 1st Flr 9884988604

TNAGAR RAMANUJAM St 1710Sft 3BHK CCP 1st Flr 5Yrs Semifund 8610299058

RESIDENTIAL FLAT - RESALE

EGMORE 1700SFT 3BHK Flat 1CCP with Amenities 2.60cr Realty. 9840172119

KOLAPPAKKAM 3BHK 1159sf UDS 617sf Primex Vertera NoahLand 9444046026

KK NAGAR 853 sqft UDS -370 sqft, 2BHK 1ygr old Rs1. 30cr.Nego:8098525237

FLAT FOR SALE @ Mambakkam Road 3 BHK Ct : 7550238441

ADYAR POSH Gated 2235sf 3BHK UDS- 525 2CCP S/F 8thFr S.Pool 9444019575

MEDAVAKAM 3BHK @ Navins Springfield CCTV Security Genset CCP 9710156179

THIRUMUDIVAKAM NAVINS 1385sf 3BR UDS-620 Lift CCP 13yrs JSK:9894999412

PALLIKARANAI IIT City Nr MRD 2BHK 865sf BUP 569 UDS CCP 55L 7824935585

PADAYATTAMMAN KOIL St, Kosapet First Flr 756 sft 2 BHK UDS 250sft. Whatsapp only 99405 70843

OMR PERUNGUDI Near Main Road 3BHK 1900sq.ft. Gated 1.75 Cr. 9941187202

BESANTNGR PRIME&POSH Flat 2500sf, 4thFrUDS-1450 W/F 2CCP Lift Genset, 10Yrs, 40ftRd, 4.50Cr. 9444019575

RESIDENTIAL HOUSE

Near Tambaram G -+1 L-925sf, B-1637sf,CCP:90% Loan Arranged 6369128844

ADYAR LAND 3220sft individual bungalow, built-up5000sft CP. 6379446589

KUNDRATHUR IND House 4BHK Nr Regd Off. CCP, Ready to Occupy. 9884514646

ANNANAGAR POSH area 60' Road cor ner 1000sf b/up 3600sf 5BHK fur nished G+3 Solar 2CCP 6.9Cr. 9840075040

Harrington Road backside Pachayapa College G +2, 2300sf, Ph:944940317

VIRUGAMBAKKAM VENKATESH Ngr Sabba ba Cly, 3822 sft, N/F, Ct. 9840992171

WALAJABAD TOWN - I. House Rs.35L Bank Loan Avl Ct:7604 93 93 93

NUNGAMBAKKAM Nr. Sterling Rd 840sf 16 b/ys2 building with 2 floors 700sf 1 BHK each Ct: 9448 34010

ANBAYUR ECR CMDA 1.5Grds 4000Sft 4BR 2CP NoBrks 7550208545/ 8754516444

ADYAR 2250SFT Land with 3BHK Duplex Prime Location 6Cr Ct: 9884068317

OMR THORAIAPPAKKAM 2600sft, 4200sft Blup G+2 Lift 4CCP 3.25Cr. 9789761666

ECR KANATHUR Nr Mayajal 2650sf Land 3300sf Buldup 2.30Cr. 9962422255

✓ ECR NEELANKARAI Opp Geetham 4BHK 4000sqft Lift New 6Cr Ct : 9884055222

ANNA NAGAR & Kilpauck Prime 23X80, 45X80, 50X80,48X100,50X100 9789928391

KODAMBAKKAM 1250 Sqft Land Old Building 2.8 crs. Ct: 9884781912

CHENNAI, MARAIMALAI Nagar GST Rd G+1 4BHK House, Rdy to Occ 9500018861

TAMBARAM West Mudichur New 3BHK Individual Villa Rs 97Lak 9940580656

PRIME PROPERTY, in T.Nagar, Near Commercial Area, Good Frontage and Size. Ct: 9030941150. Brokers Excuse.

PERAMBUR VENUS 2440Sft (61x40)Indp House Corner East 3.20Cr 9884559959

CHOOALAMEDU SBI Colony House, Land 40x60 Bulitup 4000sf 9360036003

DEFENCE COLONY, 5000 sqft land, Corner plot with old bungalow, bulidup 4500 sqft area, Ct: 9884031199

VANDALUR UNAMANCHERI Land 900Sft, Bld 1460Sft CCP Rs.80Ls Ready to Occupy Free 1AC. Contact: 9710911890

PROPERTY 1200SFT, 2mins from Villuvakkam Metro& Railway Stn 9884472728

INDIVIDUAL DUPLEX House Nr Arcot Rd @ Alwarthirunagar 4.25cr 9962579719

PERUMBABAKKAM 4BHK 5000sf villa 18530sf Land 45Cr No brk. 90941 86357

AVADI SEKKADU Nr VGN 35x57 B.1200sf, Ind. L:2350sf Appd Rs.95L 9840375148

BESNTNGR,INDP HOUSE, LAND-2630SFT. BuiltUp -3000sf. 80ftRd. 9551555949

VALMIKI NGR 4BHK BUA-8000SF UDS- 5316SF Gated Villa Options- 9840790270

MANNIVAKKAM VENKATESHWARA Ngr Land 7575sf, House 1688sf, 3BHK Duplex House. Ph: 9445003833 / 9445003837

VALASARAWAKKAM Land 3200sfst Buld ng 3200 sqft Compounded 9840051960

BESANT NAGAR Land 1050Sf+Built-Up14500sf 3.5BHK 30feetRd 3.6C 9710424556

T.NGR, 2.75GRD Opp Pothys 30ft Rd 22 Cr Old House For Sale 9841013369

ADAMBAKKAM IND House 2200sf(G+1) on 1850sf Grd. 2.5Cr nego. 9769040994

TNH8 MOGAPPAIR East 7H Bus Depo 1680sf, Ground + 1st Flr 80L Neg. goable. Call : 9840408780 / 7200045367

ABIRAMPURAM D SILVA Rd 4200Sft Land, G+3 40Ft Rd NoBroker 988498604

ECR-KANATHUR MAYAJAL Opp L+1Acre, Bnglw 8000Sft 190ft Fr 9884988604

BESANT NAGAR 1 Ground North Facing +Building 9884588199 / 9841277857

ANNA NAGAR Prime area 3600 sqft Land with Building EF 9884588199

ADYAR 5BHK independent House 40Ft Road with 2.5Grounds Land 9710156179

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ABIRAMPURAM D SILVA Rd 4200Sft Land, G+3 40Ft Rd NoBroker 9884



The factory floor of Godrej Enterprises Group's Storage Solutions manufacturing facility in Chennai. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



With locations such as Sriperumbudur and Oragadam already established as warehouse and industrial hubs, Chennai is likely to benefit from the growth of emerging locations such as Redhills and Periyapalayam in the medium term

ABHISHEK BHUTANI
Managing director of logistics & industrial services, Cushman & Wakefield

Building better warehouses

CONTINUED FROM
» PAGE 1

“PLI [production-linked incentive] schemes and Make in India initiatives boost industrial storage needs. Demand is also expanding rapidly in tier-2 and -3 cities, thus expanding storage solutions beyond the metros,” says Choudaha, adding, “Seven of 10 Coca-Cola or Pepsi bottles sold in India are from our racking systems.”

With land becoming scarce and pricey, industries are optimising available space. Choudaha says that warehouse design has evolved significantly over the past two decades. Average heights have increased from about 7m two decades ago to nearly 20m today. Godrej’s in-house engineering team designs customised storage layouts based on clients’ in-

ventory and warehouse requirements.

A manager at an e-commerce firm, formerly with an FMCG company, says, on condition of anonymity, that the Chennai floods had offered an important lesson in warehouse planning. “We realised the importance of storing goods at higher levels to prevent damage during flooding. Since then, we have been designing our storage solutions along those lines.”

Automation uptick

According to Godrej, as warehouses become larger and more technologically advanced, businesses are increasingly investing in automated storage solutions to improve efficiency and optimise space. Godrej Storage Solutions contributes nearly ₹1,500 crore to

the overall revenue of the Godrej Enterprises Group (other categories include furniture, real estate, aerospace, advanced engineering, tooling, etc.). With demand for storage solutions increasing, the company is also scouting for land near its existing facility in Ambattur Industrial Estate to set up a new plant.

Industry sources say FMCG companies and other businesses are driving much of the growth, while individuals and families relocating abroad are also increasingly using warehousing services to store household goods for a fee. Based on industry estimates and market analysis, Choudaha says the country’s vertical storage industry, also known as rack storage solutions, could nearly double to around ₹7,000 crore by 2030.

Robotic welding and automated manufacturing have improved operational efficiency at the plant by 15%-20%, according to the company.

Smarter investments

Amit Gossain, managing director, KONE India and South Asia, which is into the business of elevators and escalators, says, “At KONE, we use a mix of pallet racking, shelving and automated storage systems to maximise space and improve retrieval efficiency.” He adds, “Investment in storage solutions is typically a part of overall infrastructure and process improvement spending, and it is driven by business growth, operational efficiency needs, and automation strategies rather than a fixed percentage.”

Ashvini Jakhar, founder & CEO of supply chain company, Prozo, points out that beyond space optimisation, storage infrastructure directly impacts operational productivity, picking efficiency, inventory accuracy, and overall fulfilment speed. Prozo’s storage systems can be redeployed across facilities. “At Prozo, we use different storage systems depending on the type of inventory. Bulk



At Prozo, bulk goods are stored using space-efficient storage solutions, while individual products to be shipped are stored in shelves for faster access

ASHVINI JAKHAR
Founder & CEO, Prozo



At KONE, we use a mix of pallet racking, shelving and automated storage systems to maximise space and improve retrieval efficiency

AMIT GOSSAIN
Managing director KONE India and South Asia

goods are stored using space-efficient storage solutions, while products that are picked and shipped as individual units are stored in shelving systems for faster access,” Jakhar adds.

Ajay Rao, founder and CEO at Emiza, which operates a 19,500 sq. ft. warehouse in Chennai, says the company typically invests ₹10-₹12 crore in storage solutions and ware-

house infrastructure for large warehouses, spanning approx. 80,000-1,00,000 sq. ft., and ₹6-₹8 crore, in smaller facilities of 50,000-60,000 sq. ft. size. “The right storage approach helps businesses maximise space utilisation, reduce errors, minimise damage and handling costs, support growth and improve customer service,” Rao concludes.

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CHX



Commercial spaces need rewiring

Tenant priorities demand efficient, adaptable buildings over flashy short-term ones

Aditya Chellaram

Real estate is dangerously obsessed with the shiny and the new. Strategic insight is a flood of superficial information, recycled brochure text, and generic industry fluff repackaged as market expertise.

A huge chunk of India's legacy commercial real estate was broken from Day 1. Bad design did not do it. Short-sighted financial exit strategies did. Years ago, developers routinely chopped floor plates into tiny, split-up 2,000 to 4,000 sq. ft. blocks simply because they

needed a quick exit. They sold off pieces to individual buyers just to fund the project. That single balance-sheet move permanently ruined city architecture. It left us with narrow column grids, bad elevator banks, bloated common areas, and tight corridors.

Now, when modern enterprises try to scale up, these rigid layouts act as severe bottlenecks. Today's market demand and supply look completely different. According to the official Knight Frank India Real Estate H2 2025 Report, India's office market crossed a record high of 86.4 million sq. ft. of gross leasing in 2025. Global Capability

Centres took up 38% of that total volume.

Large corporate occupiers are not buying small, split-up boxes anymore. They want massive, single-floor plates of 30,000 to 50,000 sq. ft. This shift from fragmented property ownership to long-term corporate leasing forces a complete rewrite of future master plans and design concept.

True optimisation means planning the inside layout first. Map out exactly where the desks, meetings, and foot traffic go. Then let those internal needs dictate the building's outside architecture.

This inside-out mindset mat-

ters because workplace density has changed completely. Ratios shrank fast from 100 sq. ft. per person down to just 60 or 80 sq. ft. in most modern offices. The old 1:1 desk-to-seat ratio is dead, too. It is more like 1:0.7 now. The saved floor space goes right into breakout zones, focus pods, and casual meeting areas. Design is behavioural now, not visual.

Mirage of Capex Theatre

Packing this many people into one space puts immense pressure on a building's air and circulation systems. Right here is where many builders fall for Capex Theatre. They spend

millions on superficial upgrades such as Italian marble in the lobby or massive, flashy facades.

Real building performance needs structural focus. Data from the Knight Frank 2025 Report shows occupiers care way more about building performance now. They look closely at energy use, ventilation, indoor air quality, and daily running costs. They do not just look at location and rent. They evaluate an asset on its ability to deliver operational efficiency, tenant wellbeing, and long-term durability.

This means things like high-performance facades, efficient HVAC setups, better ventilation, natural sunlight, and smart building tech matter more than ever. Sustainability

A huge chunk of India's legacy commercial real estate was broken from Day 1. Bad design did not do it. Short-sighted financial exit strategies did. That single balance-sheet move permanently ruined city architecture. It left us with narrow column grids, bad elevator banks, bloated common areas, and tight corridors.

is not some separate green goal. It is a business metric that hits operating expenses, worker productivity, asset value, and leasing choices directly.

Legacy offices

Plenty of legacy offices perform incredibly well today. They succeed because they have strong structural frameworks, large floor plates, and great locations. The real challenge is not how old a building is. It is how well it aligns with what tenants expect around energy efficiency, tech integration, and daily operation.

Math of efficiency

The official ANAROCK-FICCI Workplaces 2025 Report shows modern occupiers prioritise green infrastructure because it cuts operational costs over time while meeting compliance goals. When you pair smart engineering with high-performance, double-glazed facades to cut solar heat gain. High ceilings let natural light pierce deep into the floor plate. This cuts energy consumption and helps people focus better.

Occupiers are tracking carpet-to-super built-up efficiency with a calculator. In a lot of regular builds, efficiency dropped from a clean 80% down to a wasteful 70% because of oversized lobbies and poorly planned service cores. A drop

like that ruins the cost-per-seat math for a company. True Grade-A real estate fixes this loss with tight grid planning. Tenants should pay for usable workspace, not space.

Shift to hotelisation

Moving from a build-and-sell mindset to long-term leasing forces builders to think like hospitality operators. We are looking at the hotelisation of commercial real estate. When you hold an asset for 20 years, you stop planning for a quick financial exit. You focus entirely on tenant comfort, predictive service, and asset longevity.

The transition forces developers to act like long-term asset custodians. When you keep an asset for decades instead of exiting early, the focus shifts from short-term transactions to long-term performance, run costs, and user experience.

The past 60 years of workspace design have been an evolution, not a correction. Every generation of office buildings reflects the priorities and technology of its time. While new builds focus on flexibility, sustainability and green features, plenty of older assets stay relevant because of their core quality and ability to adapt to newer trends.

The writer is executive director, Featherlite Developers.

Monty Joshi

The journey to purchasing a first home now begins much earlier than it used to: long before a site visit, and long before a loan discussion. Buyers spend months online comparing localities, checking developer histories, tracking metro expansion plans, calculating EMIs, and trying to understand whether a purchase made today will still make sense years later. An eXp India study tracking Google Trends between July 2025 and January 2026 recorded a 58.5% rise in property purchase searches alongside a 43.4% jump in agency inquiries. The volume reveals that people are researching harder before committing.

Part of that caution comes from affordability pressure. ANAROCK data shows that homes priced below ₹40 lakh now account for only 10% of new launches, while units above ₹1.5 crore make up 53% of supply pipelines. The entry point into urban ownership has shifted sharply upwards, causing younger buyers to become more cautious than they were a decade ago.

Earlier, homebuyers thought of buying homes for the first time as a step towards long-term settlement. The younger buyer, too, approaches property buying from the same perspective, but now the ambit of assessment also subsumes resale potential, rental fallback, and whether the home will remain financially manageable if jobs, cities, or priorities shift later.

More strategic

A first home is the single largest purchase many young professionals make in their lives, which is precisely why



First home, now an asset

Affordability pressures are reshaping how new buyers evaluate houses and future value

the decision-making process has become more thoughtful and analytical. Buyers are asking questions on hidden charges, delivery credibility, maintenance, loan flexibility, rental demand, and future liquidity.

ANAROCK's housing senti-

ment survey for H1 2025 found that 63% of respondents now consider real estate their preferred asset class. Yet 65% still identified self-use as the primary reason for purchase, suggesting that emotional and practical motivations go hand

in hand with financial thinking. Not that buyers are approaching homes like institutional investors; they are less willing to enter ownership blindly. Trust also shapes demand much more directly than before. A developer's de-

livery history and post-possession service are now front and centre in home-buying decisions. With homebuyers' confidence strengthened by RE-RA, their expectations around developer accountability have also increased.

Rent aspect

Rental-focused thinking has also moved much closer to the nucleus of purchase calculations. Rental yields across major cities remain modest at around 3%-4%, and few buyers expect rent to cover an entire EMI. But the ability to generate some income later, in the event of job changes or relocation, influences how first homes are being evaluated.

Practical usage

In these post-pandemic times, buyers look at space differently. Personal comfort and dedicated areas for everyday routines have become primary considerations, with greater attention now being paid to how a home will accommodate changing lifestyles over the next several years. Noticing this shift, developers are offering more functional floor plans. On similar lines, features such as better access to open walking areas, natural light, and layouts that reduce long-term maintenance or utility costs are also gaining importance among buyers.

Connectivity relevance

Infrastructure has always influenced housing demand, but younger buyers' evaluation of connectivity differs from that of previous generations. Earlier, proximity often meant familiarity. Staying close to established neighbourhoods or family networks. Now, the emphasis is much more on future usability. Metro corridors, expressways, redevelopment belts, and employment clusters affect first-time purchase decisions because they reduce uncertainty around what comes later and ease buyers'

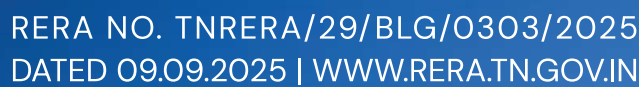
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hesitation around buying near peripheral markets. The impact is already becoming visible across several connectivity-led corridors within the Mumbai Metropolitan Region.

Demand has stayed firm for compact homes across the Mumbai Metropolitan Region, particularly in corridors witnessing redevelopment activity and improving connectivity prospects. Mid-segment housing constituted nearly 48% of Mumbai's new launches in Q1 2026, while the affordable category recovered to a 25% share after weaker quarters. Peripheral regions accounted for nearly 60% of total city sales during the quarter, with traction visible across parts of the Eastern Suburbs, Navi Mumbai, and Thane. Buyers are showing greater willingness to stretch commute distances if the trade-off brings lower entry pressure and stronger long-term usability, ensuring the property remains useful in the future.

The emotional value attached to ownership is still intact. Millennial and Gen Z buyers, however, are approaching homeownership with a more prudent understanding of how a first home may function over time. Rental fallback now figures into purchase calculations much earlier. Resale potential assumes importance from the outset. Hybrid work routines and movement across cities have also altered perceptions around permanence. Therefore, developers catering to younger buyers will have to contend with this change in thinking while planning homes and communities that stay financially workable across changing stages of life.

The writer is co-founder of Sarvam Properties.



IN CHENNAI'S MOST COVETED NEIGHBOURHOOD.

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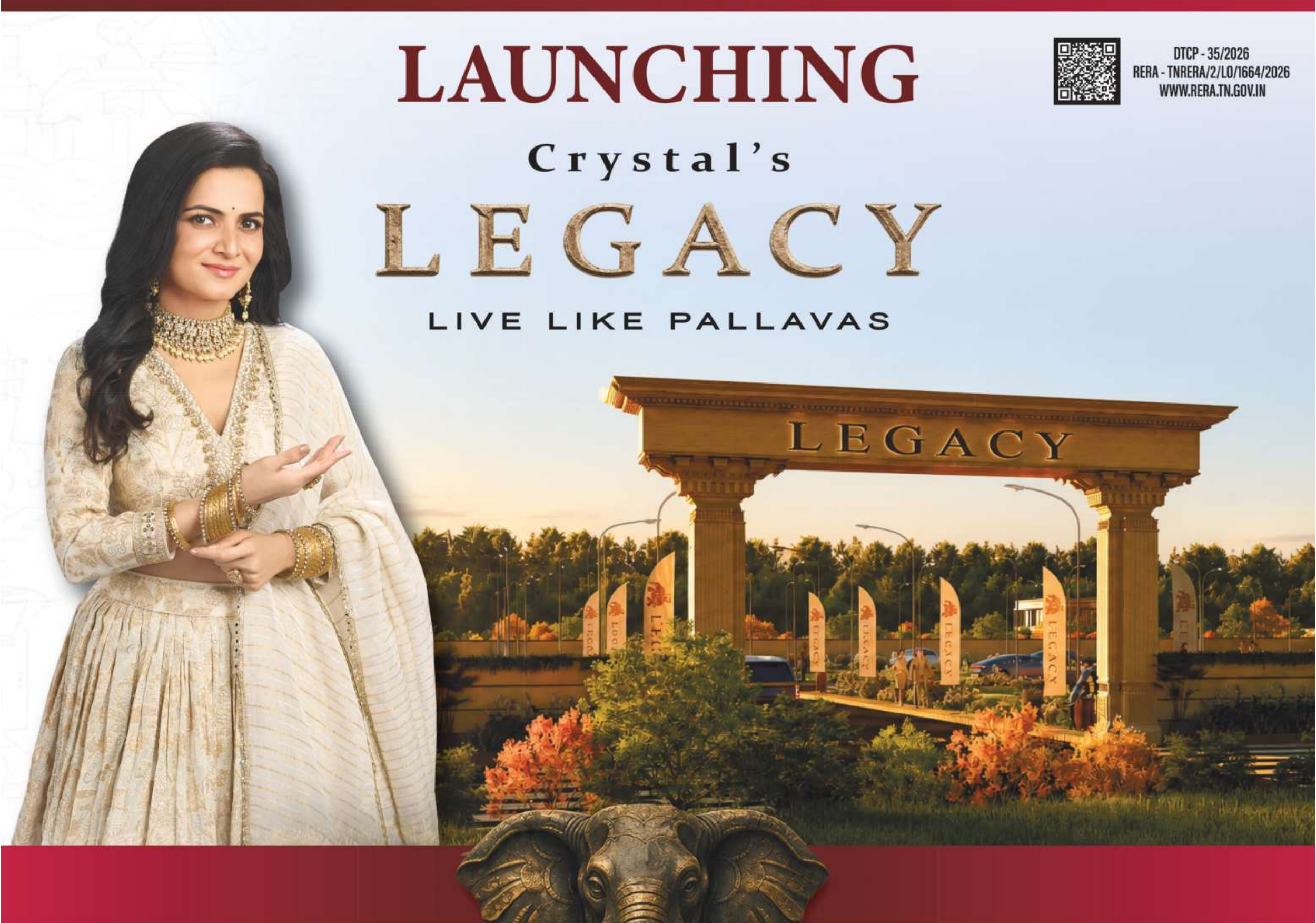
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